

Phishing Email Detection & Awareness Report

Cyber Security Task 2 (2026)

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1. Introduction

Phishing is a cyber attack where attackers try to trick users into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, OTPs, or financial details. These attacks mainly target human behavior rather than technical systems.

2. Objective

- Analyze phishing email samples
 - Identify phishing indicators
 - Classify email risk
 - Create awareness for users
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3. Tools Used

- Google Admin Toolbox (Message Header Analyzer)
 - MXToolbox Email Header Analyzer
 - Web Browser (for safe link inspection)
 - MS Word / PDF for documentation
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4. Sample Phishing Email Analysis

Email Details

Subject: Urgent: Your Account Will Be Locked

Sender: security@secure-update.com

Email Body:

Dear User,

We noticed suspicious activity on your account. To avoid account suspension, please verify your details immediately.

Verify Now: <http://secure-account-verify.com>

Failure to verify within 24 hours will result in permanent account lock.

Regards,
Security Team

5. Identified Phishing Indicators

Indicator	Description
Fake Sender Domain	Email domain is not official or trusted
Urgency Language	"Immediate action", "24 hours" creates panic
Suspicious Link	URL does not match official domain
Generic Greeting	Uses "Dear User" instead of real name
Threat Message	Account lock warning to force action

6. Risk Classification

Classification: PHISHING (High Risk)

Reason:

- Fake domain detected
 - Malicious link present
 - Social engineering tactics used
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7. How the Attack Works (Simple Explanation)

The attacker sends a fake email pretending to be a trusted company. The message creates fear and urgency so that the user clicks the link quickly without thinking. Once clicked, the user is taken to a fake website where login details are stolen.

8. Prevention Guidelines

Do's

- Always check sender email address
- Hover over links before clicking
- Use official websites directly
- Report suspicious emails to IT team

Don'ts

- Do not click unknown links
 - Do not share OTPs or passwords
 - Do not trust urgent messages blindly
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9. Employee Awareness Tips

- Think before you click
 - Verify before you trust
 - Report immediately if unsure
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10. Conclusion

Phishing attacks are increasing because they exploit human mistakes. Awareness and careful checking are the best defenses. Employees should be trained regularly to identify phishing emails and avoid becoming victims.

11. GitHub Repository Structure (Suggested)

- README.md
- phishing-report.pdf
- sample-emails/
- analysis/

README Content:

- Tools used
 - Analysis approach
 - Key findings
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End of Report